

Periodic policy shrinkage reproduces the whole PT-PPO apparatus

pt_full vs PPO + shrinkage: +49 ($p = 0.485$, indistinguishable) · both vs vanilla: $p = 0.002$

50

vanilla PPO

PPO + shrinkage

pt_full (live permanent)

711

760

551

pt_full (frozen permanent)

-250

final-phase return (6 seeds, HalfCheetah, 3.07M steps)

250

500

750

1000

1250

exact permutation test, $p = 0.485$ · seed spread: vanilla 787 vs PPO + shrinkage 49 (16x tighter)